

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

BOARD ORDER NO. 6-84-90

REVISED WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR

LEE VINING PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT
Mono County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region finds:

1. The Board previously established waste discharge requirements for the Lee Vining Public Utility District under Board Order No. 6-78-50, which was adopted on August 3, 1978. For the purposes of this order, the Lee Vining Public Utility District is hereinafter referred to as the "discharger".
2. The Board is revising waste discharge requirements to update requirements and reflect the construction of two additional percolation ponds.
3. The Lee Vining Public Utility District, which is located approximately 24 miles (39 km) north of the community of Mammoth Lakes collects, treats and disposes of a maximum of 0.076 mgd (3.3 l/s) of domestic wastewater. The treatment and disposal facilities are located in the Mono Hydrologic Unit within Section 9, T1N, R26E, MDB&M as shown on Attachment "A", which is made a part of this order.
4. The community of Lee Vining is a community supported to a large extent by tourists traveling Highway 395 and the Tioga Pass route during the summer months. The estimated maximum 24-hour flow during the tourist season is 0.076 mgd (3.3 l/s).
5. Wastewater treatment is provided by a large septic tank which has three compartments. The design capacity of the septic tank is 0.13 mgd (5.7 l/s). The septic tank effluent is discharged to five percolation ponds for disposal. Disposal of septage is accomplished by pumping the contents of the septic tank to a septage drying bed. The septage drying bed is the most northeasterly pond of the four ponds that were in existence prior to 1979. During 1979 two additional percolation ponds were constructed. Dried septage in the drying bed is disposed of by discing the septage into the bottom of the drying bed. The disposal capacity of the percolation ponds is estimated to be slightly more than 0.076 mgd (3.3 l/s).
6. The five percolation ponds are the only designated disposal site.

7. Lee Vining Creek is located approximately 250 feet (75.2 m) east of the designated disposal site, and at this point the creek is at least 100 feet (31 m) lower in elevation than the disposal site. Subsurface flow from the designated disposal site migrates toward Mono Lake and Lee Vining Creek. Due to stream diversions Lee Vining Creek is ephemeral in the vicinity of the disposal ponds. No information is available on the quality of groundwater underlying the disposal site; however, the underlying groundwater is believed to be in a transition zone of saline groundwater from Mono Lake and fresh groundwater from the Sierra Nevada Mountains.
8. The designated disposal site is located on land owned by the City of Los Angeles and administered by the City of Los Angeles, Department of Water and Power.
9. The Board adopted the Water Quality Control Plan for the South Lahontan Basin on May 8, 1975, and this order implements that plan.
10. The beneficial uses of groundwaters of the Mono Hydrologic Unit as set forth and defined in the plan are:
 - a. municipal and domestic supply
 - b. agricultural supply
 - c. industrial service
 - d. freshwater replenishment
11. The beneficial uses of Lee Vining Creek below the diversions as set forth and defined the plan are:
 - a. water-contact recreation
 - b. noncontact-water recreation
 - c. wildlife habitat
 - d. cold freshwater habitat
 - e. groundwater recharge
12. The Board has notified the discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to revise waste discharge requirements for this discharge.
13. These waste discharge requirements govern an existing facility which the discharger is currently operating, and is therefore exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21000 et seq.) in accordance with Section 15301, Chapter 3, Title 14, California Administrative Code.
14. The Board in a public meeting heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, that the discharger shall comply with the following:

I. DISCHARGE SPECIFICATIONS

A. EFFLUENT LIMITATIONS

1. The total flow of wastewater to the treatment and disposal facilities during a 24-hour period shall not exceed 0.076 million gallons (0.29 megaliters).
2. The discharge of wastewater except to the designated disposal site is prohibited.
3. The discharge to waters of the State shall contain no trace elements, pollutants or contaminants, or combinations thereof, in concentrations which are toxic or harmful to humans or to aquatic or terrestrial plant or animal life.

B. RECEIVING WATER LIMITATIONS

1. The waste discharge shall not result in any perceptible color, odor, taste or foaming in surface or groundwaters of the Mono Hydrologic Unit.
2. The discharge shall not result in coliform organisms attributable to human wastes to be present in the surface or groundwaters of the Mono Hydrologic Unit.
3. The discharge shall not cause there to be in any surface or groundwater of the Mono Hydrologic Unit toxic substances that individually, collectively or cumulatively cause detrimental physiological responses in human, plant, animal, or aquatic life.

C. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

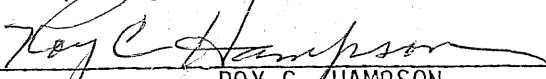
1. There shall be no discharge, bypass or diversion of raw or partially treated sewage, sewage sludge, grease or oils from the collection, transport, treatment or disposal facilities to adjacent land areas or surface waters.
2. Surface flow or visible discharge of sewage or sewage effluent from the designated disposal site to adjacent land areas or surface water is prohibited.
3. All facilities used for collection, transport, treatment or disposal of wastes shall be adequately protected against either structural damage or a significant reduction in efficiency resulting from a storm or flood having a recurrence interval of once in 100 years.

4. The vertical distance between the water surface elevation and the lowest point of a pond dike or the invert of an overflow structure shall not be less than 1.5 feet (0.46 m).
5. The discharge shall not cause a pollution.
6. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance.

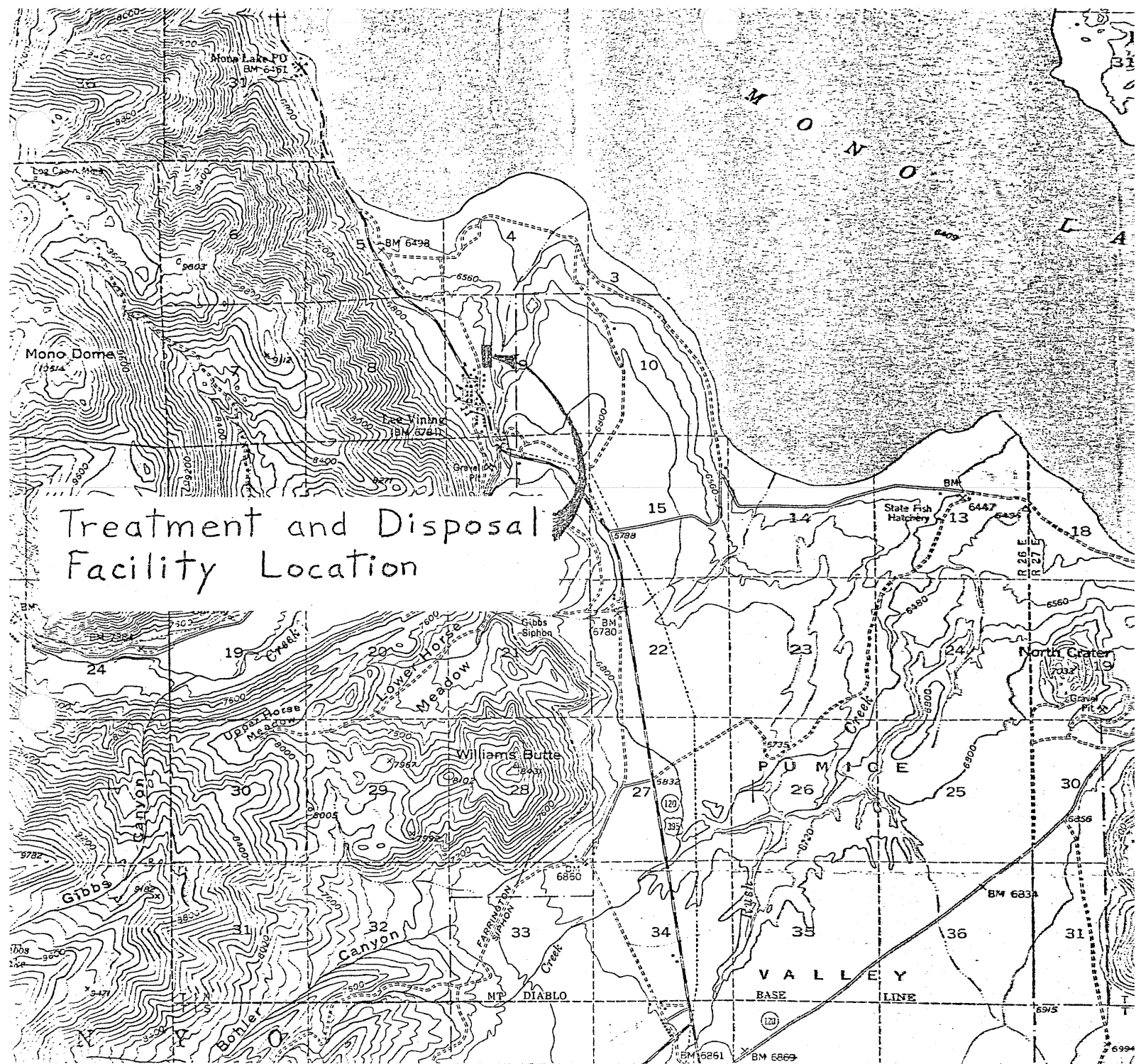
II. PROVISIONS

1. Board Order No. 6-78-50 is hereby rescinded.
2. The discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 84-90 as specified by the Executive Officer.
3. The discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board by telephone whenever an adverse condition occurs as a result of this discharge; written confirmation shall follow.
4. Any proposed material change in the character of the waste, manner or method of treatment or disposal, increase of discharge, or location of discharge shall be reported to this Regional Board at least ninety (90) days in advance of implementation of any such proposal.
5. The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region hereby reserves the privilege of changing all or any portion of this order upon legal notice to and after opportunity to be heard is given to all concerned parties.
6. Surface waters, as used in this order, include, but are not limited to, live streams, either perennial or ephemeral, which flow in natural or artificial watercourses and natural lakes and artificial impoundments of waters within the State of California.
7. The discharger's wastewater treatment plant shall be supervised by persons possessing a wastewater treatment plant operator certificate of appropriate grade pursuant to Chapter 3, Subchapter 14, Title 23, California Administrative Code.
8. The owner of property subject to waste discharge requirements shall be considered to have a continuing responsibility for ensuring compliance with applicable waste discharge requirements in the operation or use of the owned property. Any change in the ownership and/or operation of property subject to waste discharge requirements shall be reported to this Regional Board. Notification of applicable waste discharge requirements shall be furnished the new owner(s) and/or operator(s). A copy of such notification shall be sent to this Regional Board.

I, Roy C. Hampson, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true and correct copy of an order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region on July 13, 1984.



ROY C. HAMPSON
EXECUTIVE OFFICER



Attachment "A"

Lee Vining Public Utility District

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 84-90

FOR

LEE VINING PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT
Mono County

FLOW MONITORING

The following shall be recorded quarterly:

1. The estimated population served by the Lee Vining Public Utility District sewer system.
2. A list of the types and numbers of connections to the Lee Vining Public Utility District collection system.
3. From the information determined for Paragraph 1 and 2 above, estimate the average daily flowrate to the treatment plant.
4. The freeboard (vertical distance from the lowest point of a dike or invert of an overflow structure to the water surface in a pond) of each pond shall be recorded each month. If a pond does not contain wastewater, indicate that it is empty.

OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

A brief summary of any operational problems and maintenance activities shall be submitted to the Regional Board with each monitoring report.

This summary shall discuss:

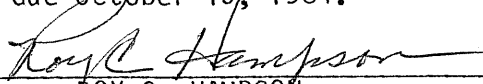
1. Any modifications or additions to the wastewater conveyance system, treatment facilities, or disposal facilities.
2. Any major maintenance conducted on the wastewater conveyance system, treatment facilities, or disposal facilities.
3. Any major problems occurring in the wastewater conveyance system, treatment facilities, or disposal facilities.
4. The date that the septic tank was last pumped, the volume of waste pumped, the point of disposal, and the person or company doing the work should also be recorded.

The name of all treatment plant operators and their grade of certification shall be reported in the first monitoring report submitted during each year.

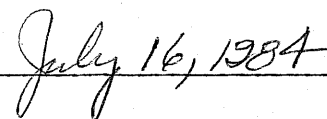
REPORTING

Quarterly monitoring reports including the preceding information shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the 15th day of the following quarter. The first report is due October 15, 1984.

Ordered by:


ROY C. HAMPSON
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Dated:


July 16, 1984